

4-Square Champion keeping sport alive in Northbridge

Completed in November 2023, the Northbridge Playground & Recreation Committee spearheaded the successful enhancement to the Linwood Courts. This endeavor brought about new and improved basketball, pickleball and 4-square courts. What's truly inspiring is that the addition of the 4-square court was a thoughtful inclusion after recognizing that the reigning World Champion in this alternative sport hails from our very own Northbridge.

Eric Costanza, 42, clinched the prestigious 2023 World Championship title, showcasing his exceptional skills in a game he mastered as a child. Now, in his effort to give back to his community, he aims to use his triumph as a platform to mentor and coach children the very game he loves. From August 5th - 7th, Costanza is hosting a fun-filled 4-square camp tailored for kids from ages 7-13. Reflecting on the importance of

outdoor activity in today's digital age, he emphasizes, "In an era where technology often consumes our children's time, it's crucial to provide opportunities for them to stay active, make new friends, enjoy the outdoors, and most importantly, have fun."

The three-day camp, designated to accommodate all skill levels, is still accepting registrations. Interested participants can scan the QR code below or reach out to Costanza directly at eric-costanza@yahoo.com.

In related news, Costanza defended his World Championship crown on May 4th in Bridgton, Maine. The competition witnessed a growing number of challengers as opponents from Virginia, Texas and even England attended all vying to dethrone the reigning champion. Affectionately known as "The Assassin" in the 4-square community, the champ described, "I wasn't sneak-



ing up on anyone this time." Having dazzled the crowd in attendance with diving returns and under-the-leg slams, Costanza found himself in a two-square one-on-one battle against a former three-time World Champ in his own right.

Both down to their last out before being eliminated, the two volleyed in an epic back-and-forth showdown which seemed to go on forever. Eventually, Costanza was bested and graciously handed over his World Championship status, though, was awarded and recognized as the Senior World Champion given to the best player in the world over age 40.

When asked if he was disappointed, "I have high standards for myself so I have a twinge of disappointment. Ultimately, experiencing this event has been invaluable, and it fuels my determination to reclaim the overall title next year."

Eric Costanza with his son CJ, after winning the 2024 Senior World Championship in Maine last month. Also at left, pictured with additional 2023 World Championship Trophy.

